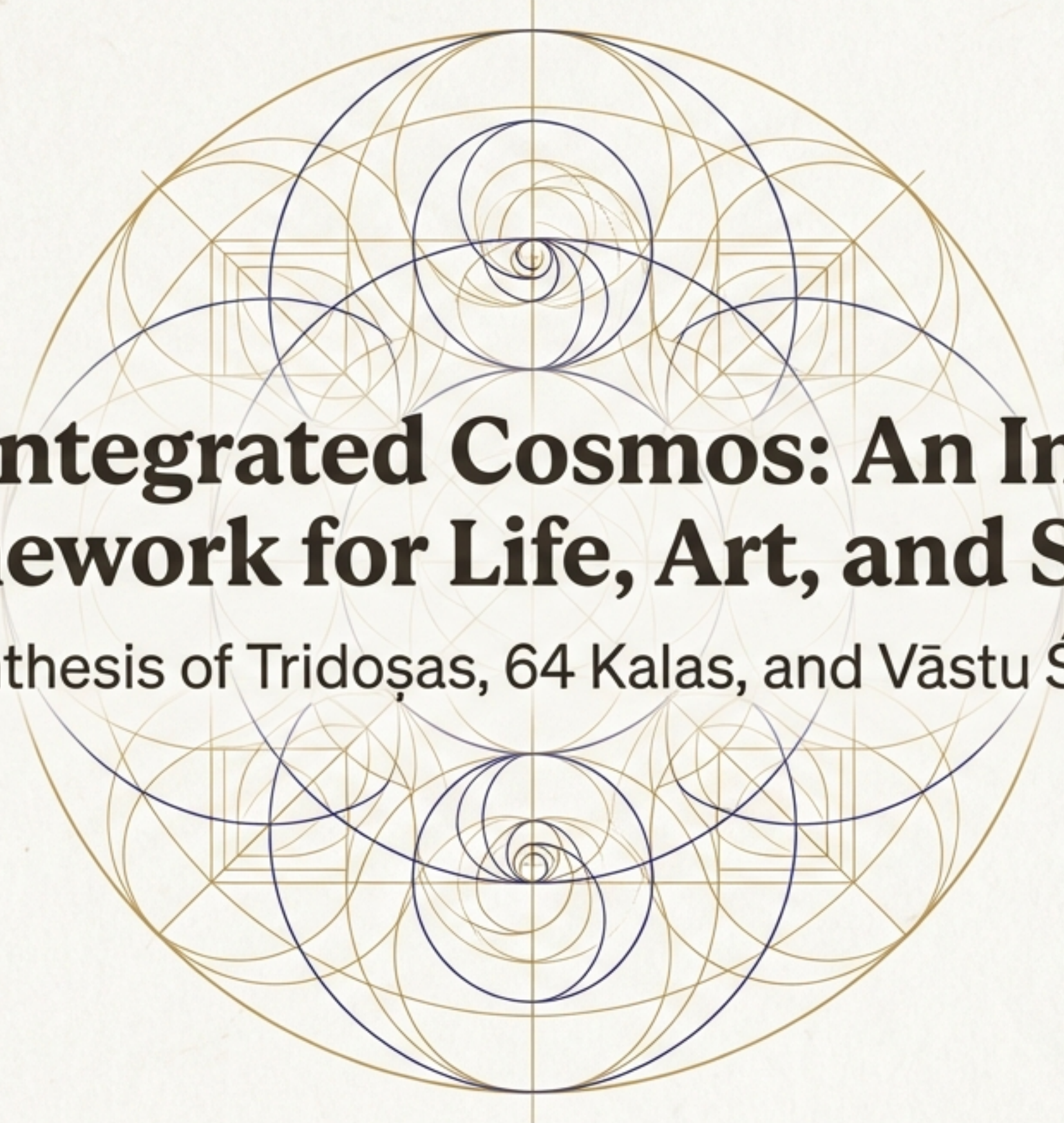
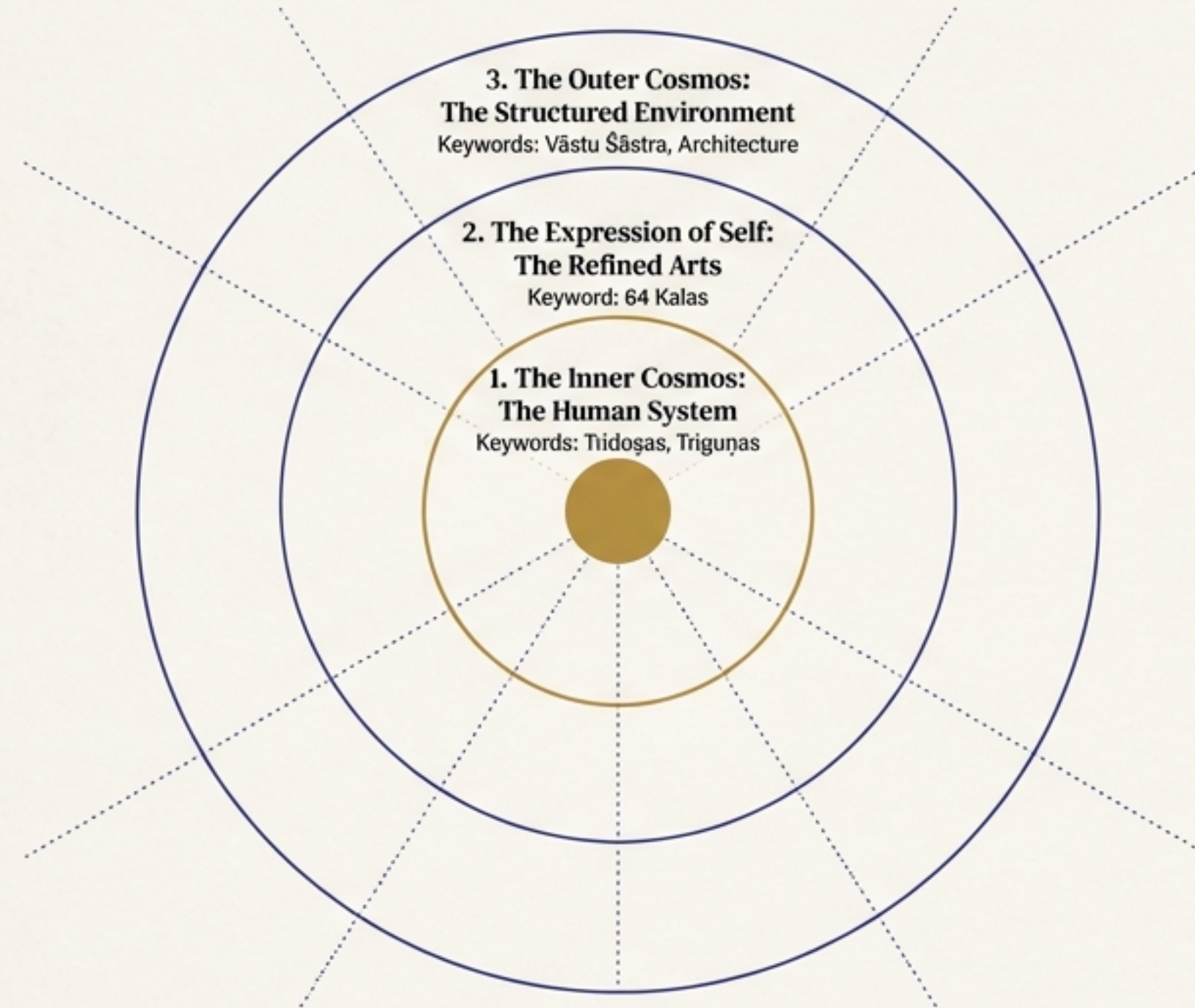




The Integrated Cosmos: An Indian Framework for Life, Art, and Space

A Synthesis of Tridoṣas, 64 Kalas, and Vāstu Śāstra

A Journey from the Self to the Cosmos



This journey explores how Indian Knowledge Systems connect the fundamental principles of the human body and mind to the highest expressions of art and the sacred design of our environment.

The Body's Operating System: The Three Doṣas

Vāta, Pitta, and Kapha as the governing principles of all psycho-physiological functions.



Vāta (Movement)

Air + Ether

Governs motion, nerve impulses, circulation, respiration, and elimination.

Light, Dry, Cold, Mobile, Subtle



Pitta (Transformation)

Fire + Water

Governs metabolism, digestion, thermoregulation, vision, and enzymatic actions

Hot, Sharp, Light, Liquid, Spreading



Kapha (Cohesion)

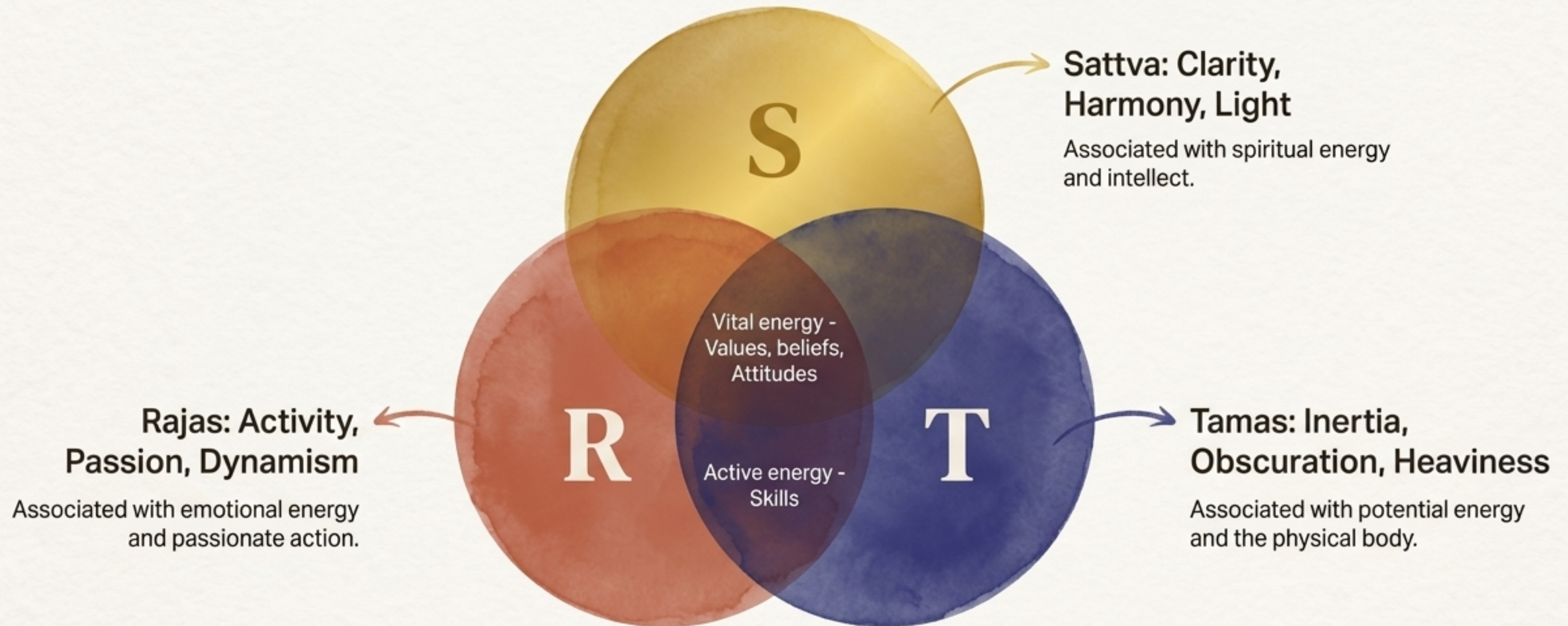
Water + Earth

Governs structure, lubrication, immunity, growth, and stability.

Heavy, Slow, Cool, Oily, Smooth

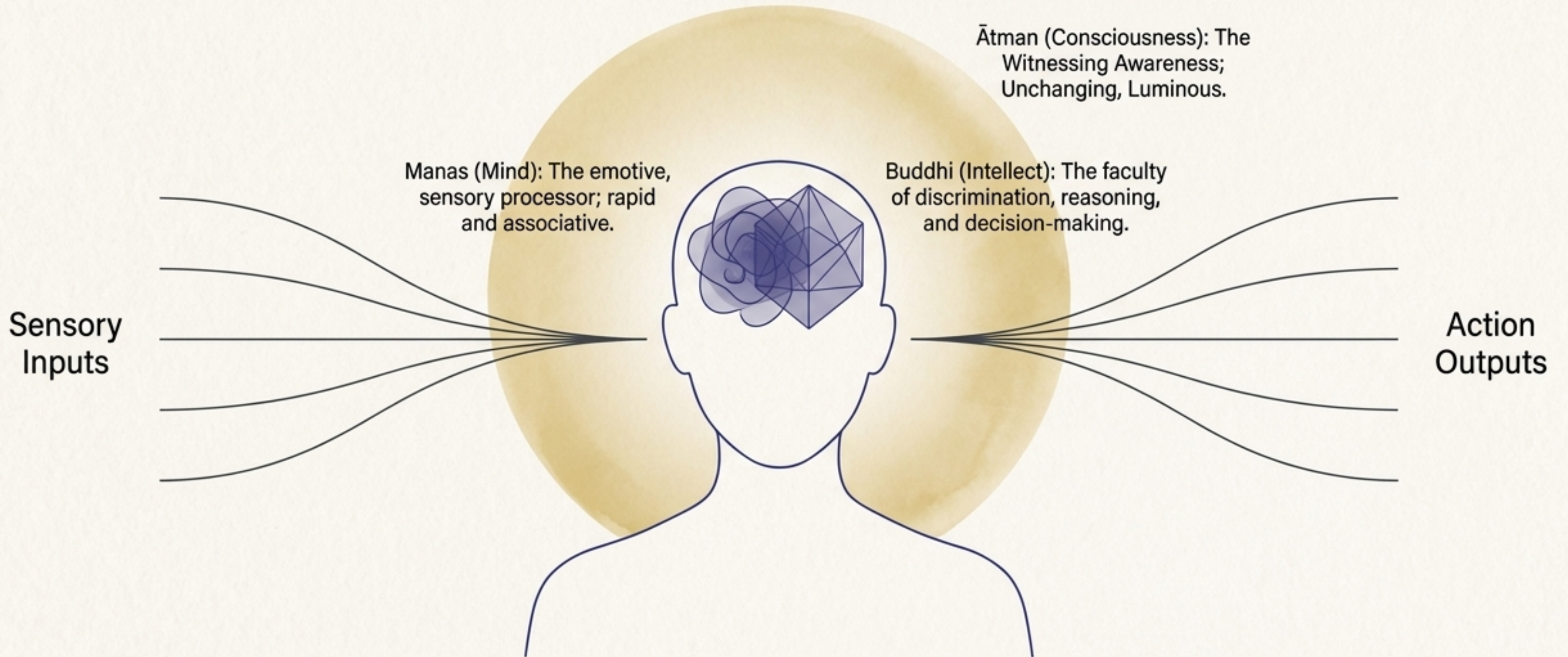
The Mind's Palette: The Three Guṇas

Sattva, Rajas, and Tamas as the fundamental qualities of consciousness that shape perception and behavior.



The Integrated Self: A Unified Architecture

Understanding the interaction of the Body, Mind, Intellect, and Consciousness (BMI-C).



Sense data reaches the Mind (Manas), is evaluated by the Intellect (Buddhi), and leads to actions via the Body (Śarīra). Consciousness (Ātman) is the background awareness in which this entire process is observed.

From Being to Doing: The Curriculum of a Complete Life

The 64 Arts (Chatuḥṣaṣṭi Kalā) as a framework for holistic human development.

The 64 Kalas represent a classical curriculum of skills for a cultured individual. Described in texts like the *Kama Sutra*, they symbolize the complete refinement of mind, body, and social conduct, integrating art, science, and life.

A Universe of Skill: The Six Domains of Mastery

1. Fine Arts & Performance

Singing, dance, drama, painting, martial arts.



2. Crafts & Utility

Weaving, floral craft, culinary skills, water sports.



3. Sciences & Knowledge

Poetics, logic, cryptography, polity, strategy.



4. Nature & Life Sciences

Horticulture (Vṛkṣāyurveda), animal training, toxicology.



5. Engineering & Design

Woodwork, metallurgy, mechanics, instrument-making.



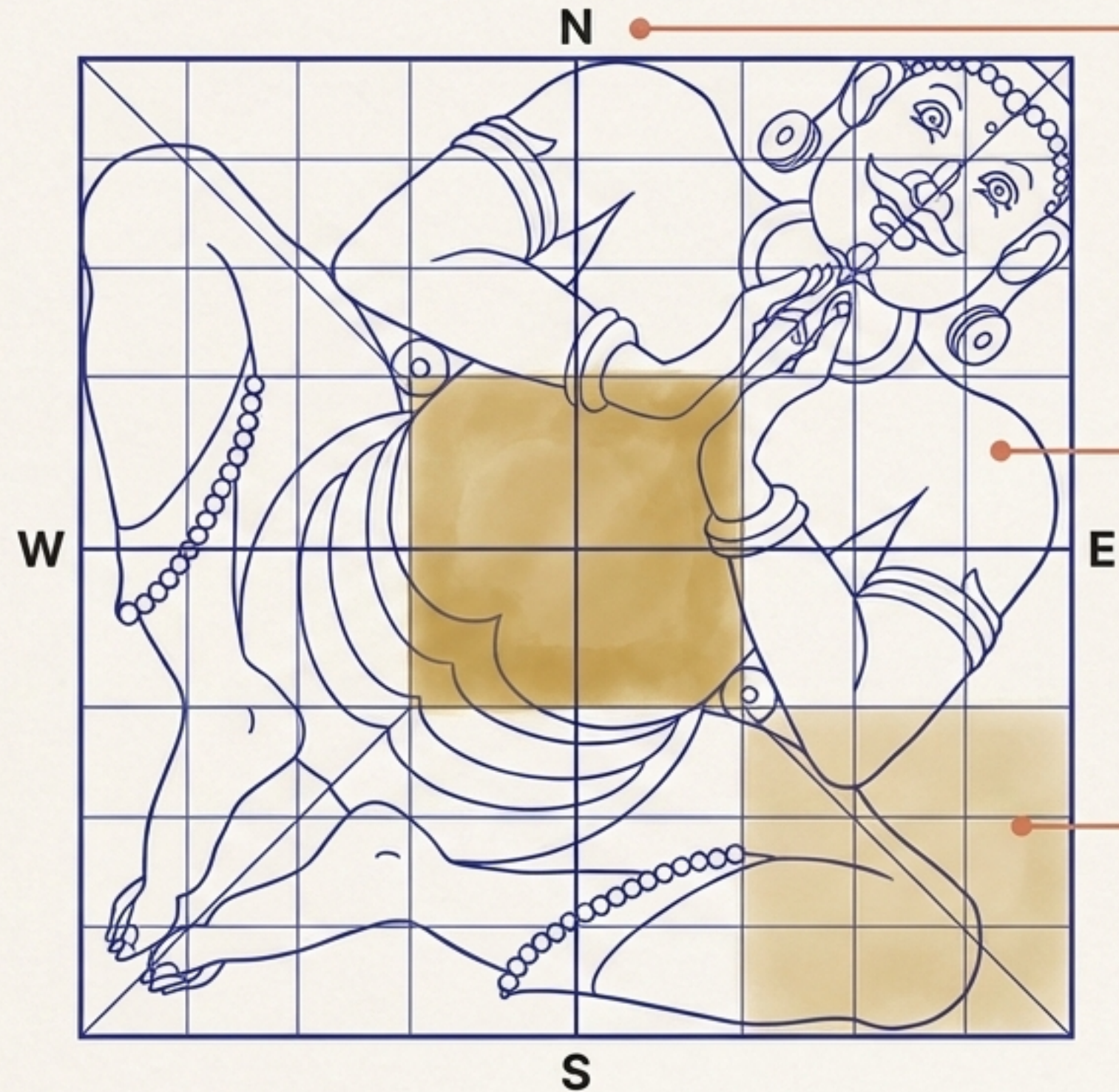
6. Miscellaneous Skills

Storytelling, festival planning, rhetoric, household harmonization.



Building in Harmony: The Science of Vāstu Śāstra

Vāstu Śāstra is the traditional Indian science of architecture that aligns human dwellings with the cosmos. It integrates the five elements (Pañca Mahābhūta), cardinal directions, and the flow of energy (Prāṇa).

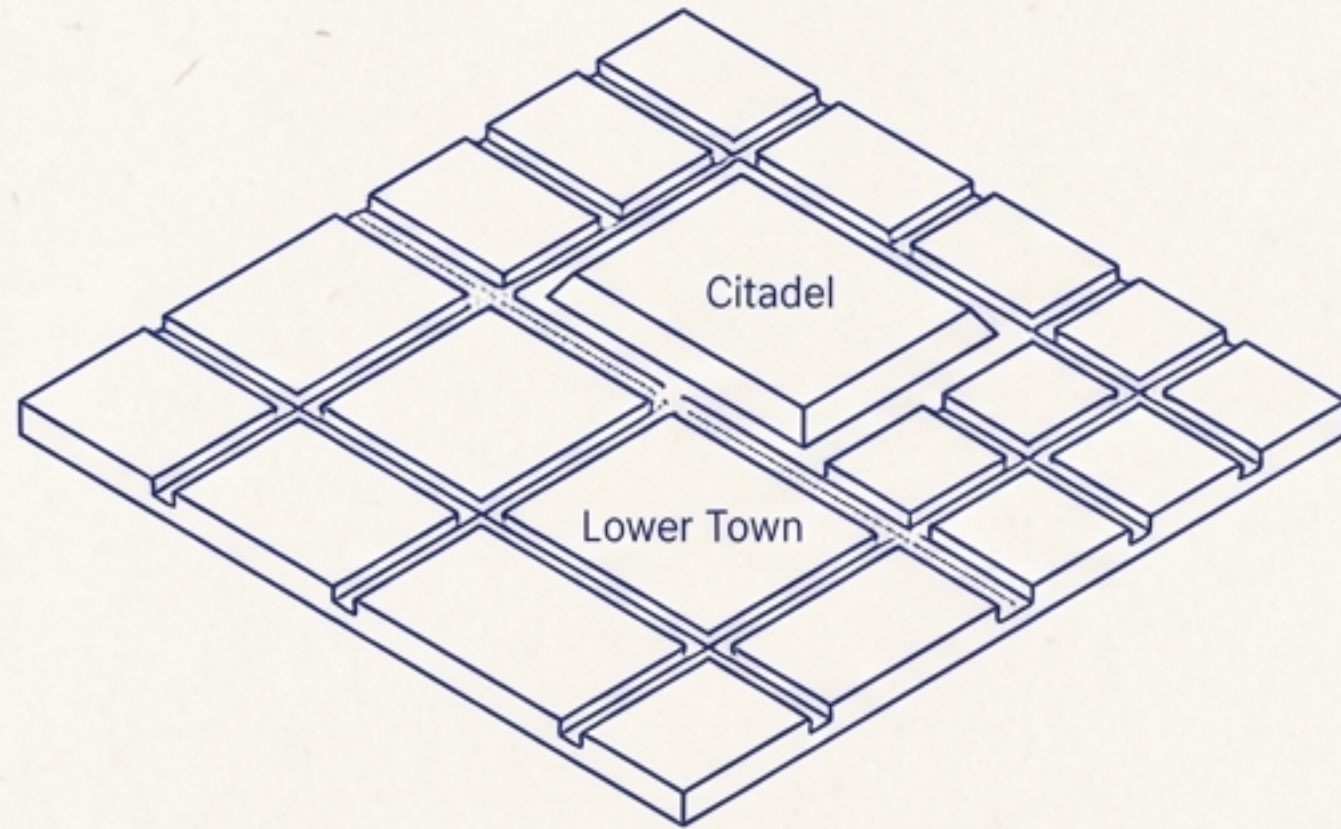


Orientation: Alignment with cardinal directions.

Energy Zones: The Maṇḍala as a geometric grid mapping cosmic energies.

- **Functional Zoning:** Allocating spaces based on activity and energy type.

Blueprints for a Balanced Society: Ancient Town Planning



Rational & Functional

- Streets at right angles
- Zoning (Citadel & Lower Town)
- Advanced drainage systems

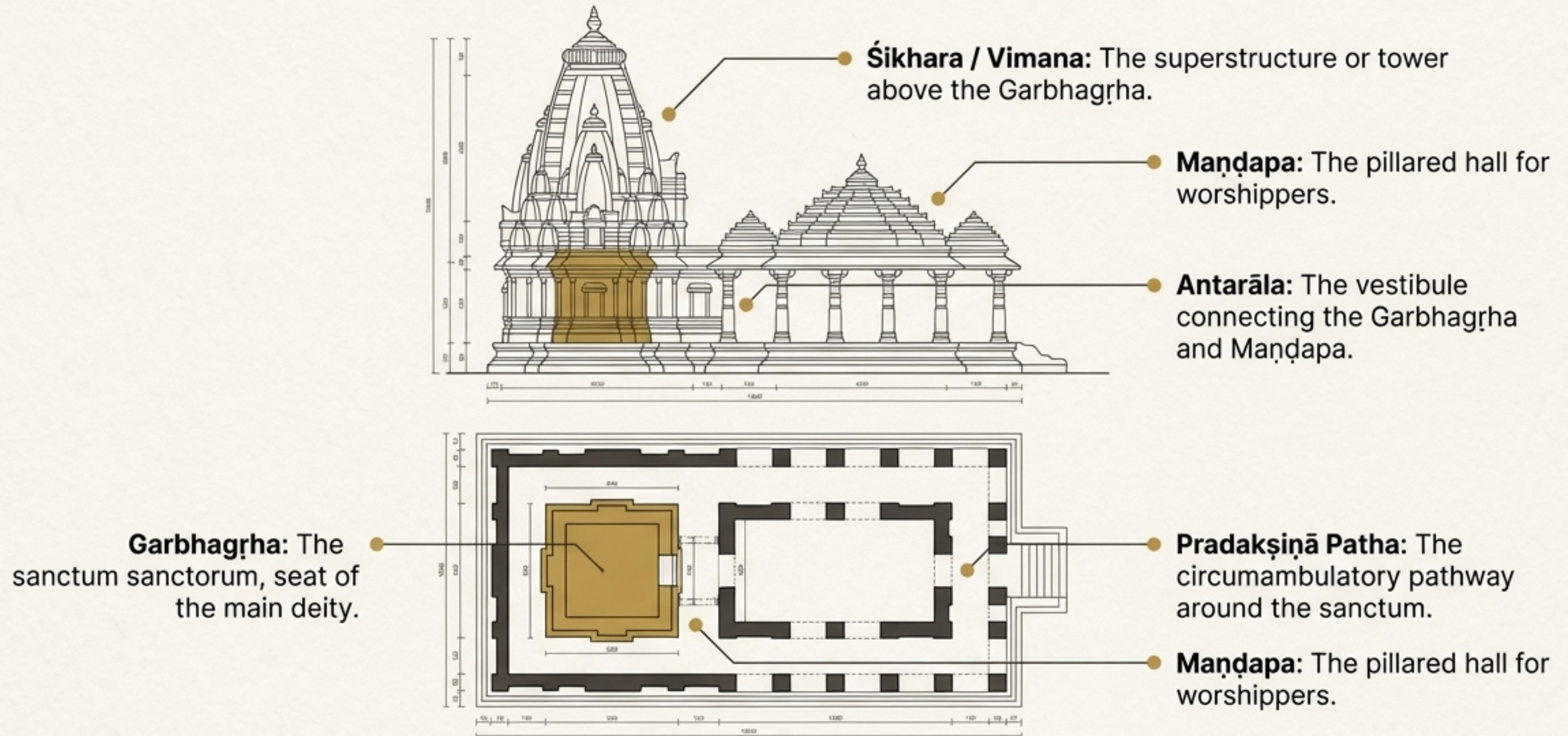


Symbolic & Centered

- Layout based on Vāstu Purusha Maṇḍala
- Temple or palace at the center
- Streets aligned with cardinal directions

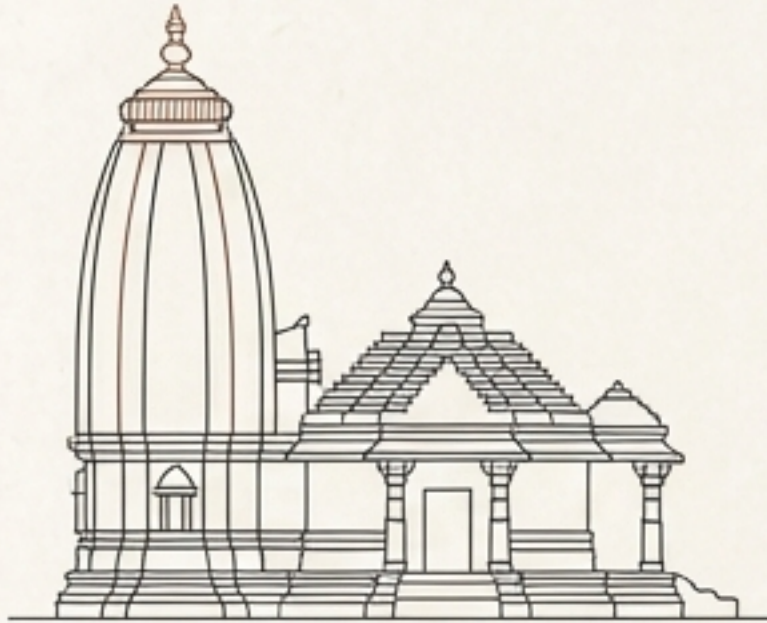
From the earliest scientific urban planning of the Indus Valley to the Vāstu-based layouts of later periods, Indian town planning consistently reflects a deep commitment to order, function, and harmony.

Anatomy of a Temple: A Model of the Universe



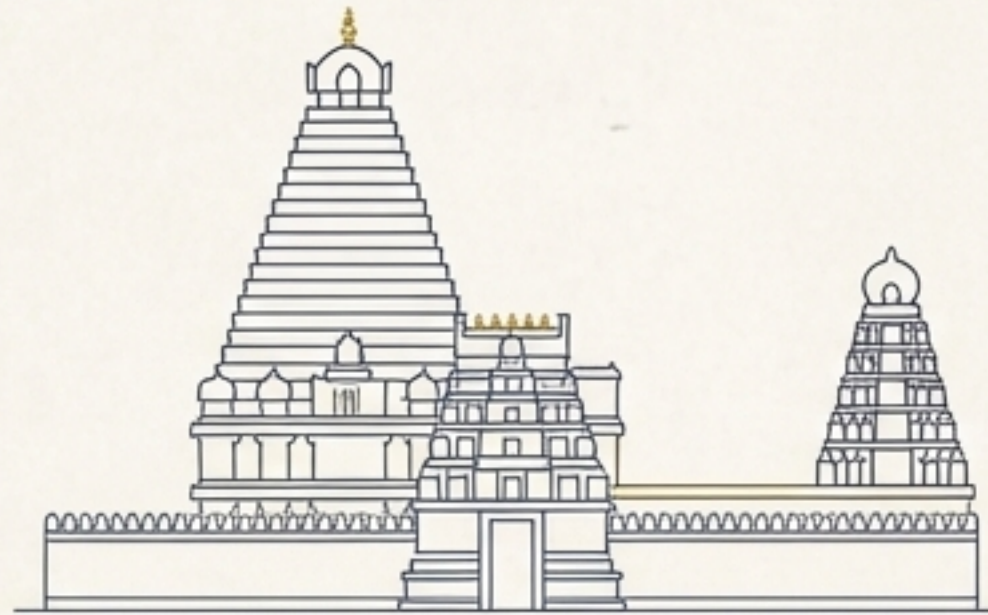
A Regional Language of Form: The Three Major Temple Styles

Nāgara (North India)



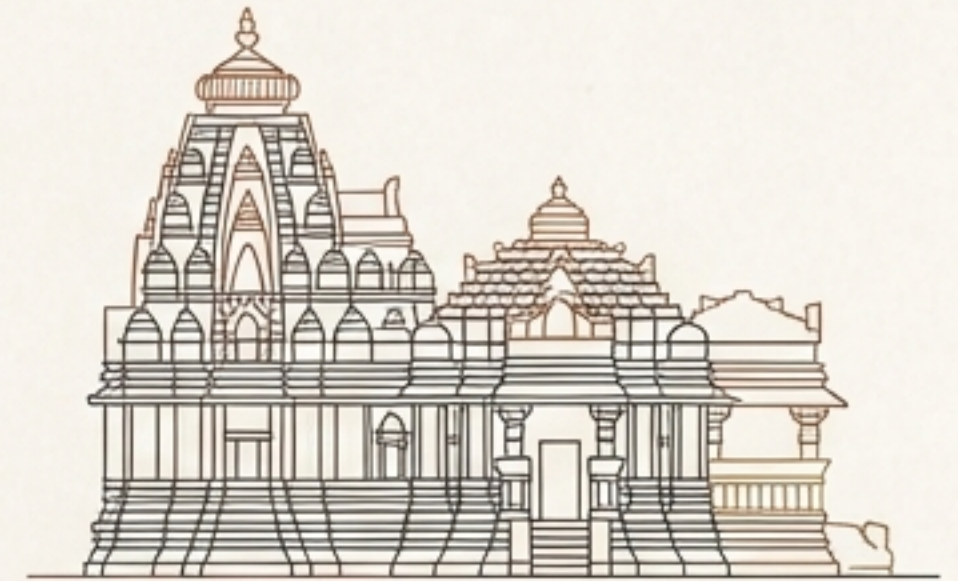
- Curvilinear Śikhara
- Amalaka and Kalasha on top
- No large boundary walls in early forms

Drāviḍa (South India)



- Pyramidal Vimana (tower)
- Massive Gopurams (gateway towers)
- Large temple complexes

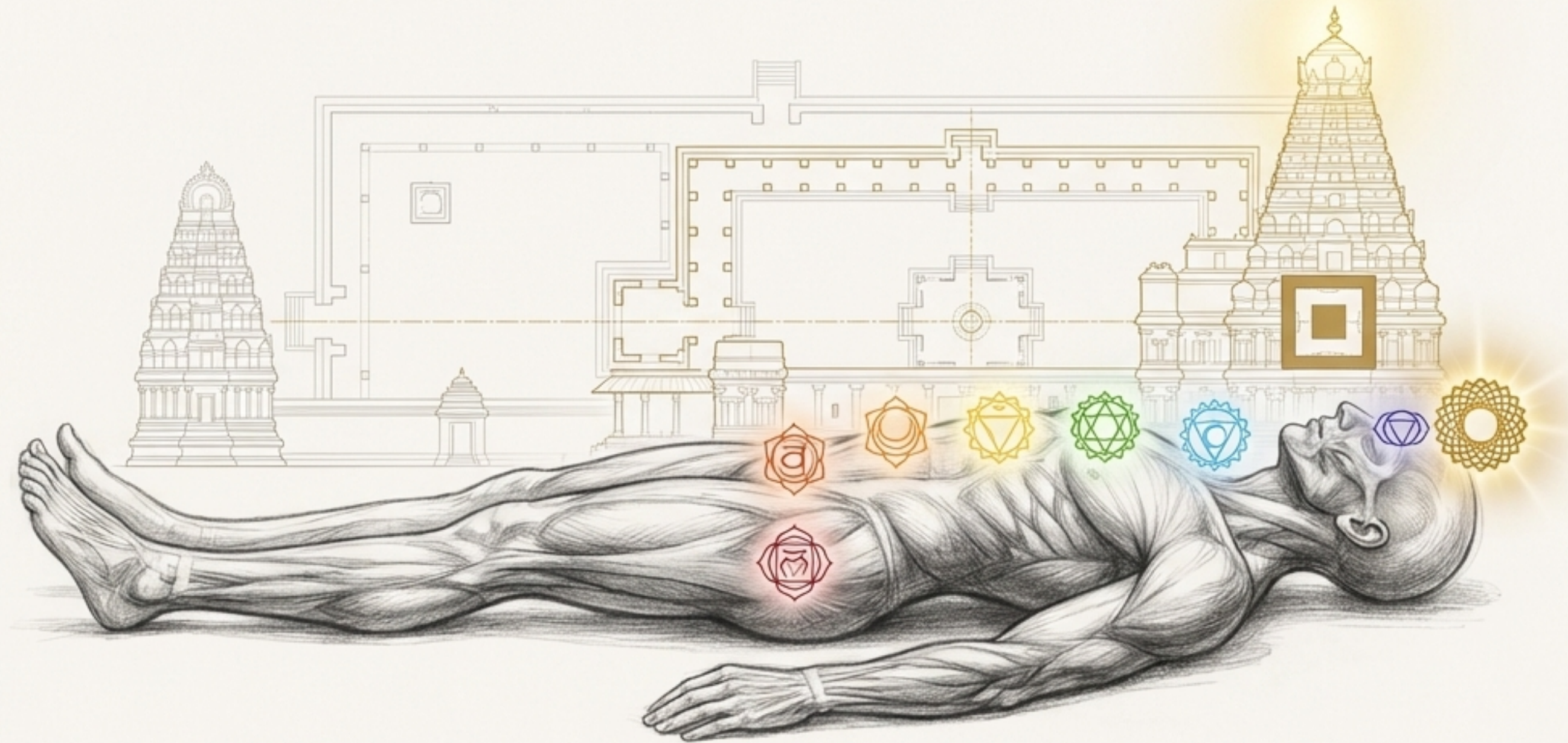
Vesara (Deccan Region)



- Hybrid of Nāgara and Drāviḍa elements
- Star-shaped plans are common
- Intricate carvings

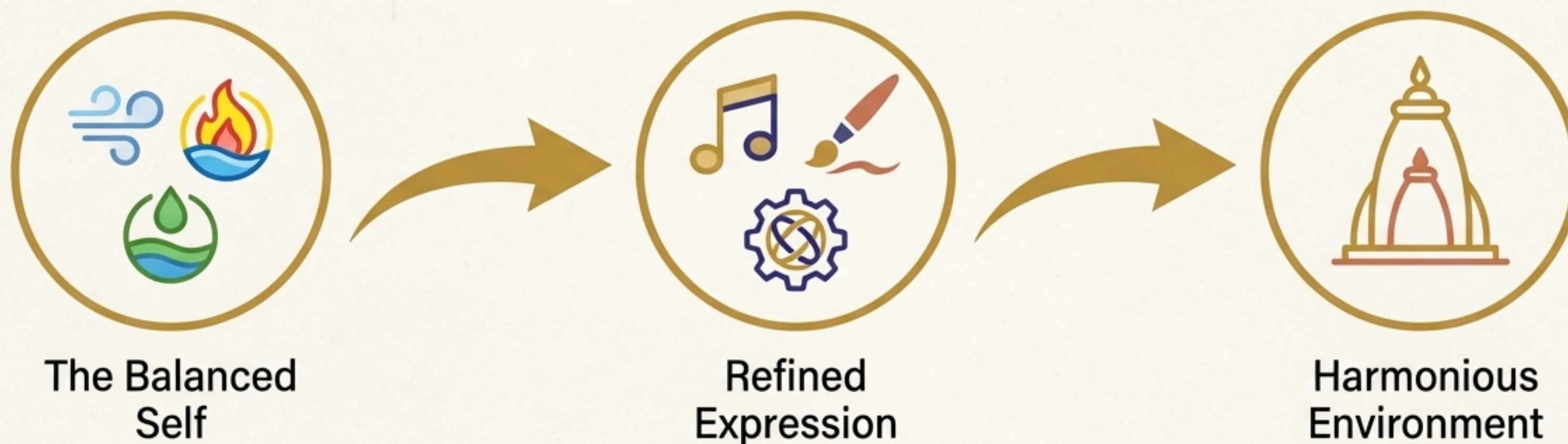
“As is the Cosmos, So is the Temple, So is the Body”

in Roslindale Display, bold charcoal



The Indian temple is the ultimate expression of the microcosm-macrocosm principle. Its architecture is a physical representation of the human body, which in turn is a reflection of the universe. The ascent through the temple is symbolic of the spiritual ascent of the individual.

The IKS Worldview: A Coherent System Across Scales



Indian Knowledge Systems present an integrated framework where the harmony of the self, the refinement of skills, and the structure of the environment are understood as reflections of the same universal principles.

A Glossary for Your Journey

Tridoṣa: The three functional bio-regulators—Vāta (movement), Pitta (transformation), and Kapha (cohesion).

Triguṇa: The three qualities of nature shaping mental states—Sattva (clarity), Rajas (activity), and Tamas (inertia).

BMI-C: The Body-Mind-Intellect-Consciousness complex; a model of the functional architecture of the human being.

Kalas: The 64 classical arts and skills forming a curriculum for a refined life.

Vāstu Śāstra: The traditional Indian science of architecture and spatial harmony.

Nāgara: The North Indian style of temple architecture, characterized by a curvilinear tower (śikhara).

Drāviḍa: The South Indian style of temple architecture, characterized by a pyramidal tower (vimana) and large gateways (gopurams).

Continue Your Inquiry

For deeper exploration of these topics, consider the following classical texts:

On Psycho-Physiology

Charaka Saṃhitā, Suśruta Saṃhitā

On Mental Qualities

Sāṃkhya Kārikā, Bhagavad Gītā (Chapters 14, 17)

On the 64 Arts

Kama Sutra of Vatsyayana

On Architecture

Mānasāra, Mayamata